

CHINONSO KALU

SOFTWARE ENGINEER | BACKEND ARCHITECTURE & SYSTEMS AUTOMATION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Performance-driven Software Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing, architecting, and scaling enterprise web platforms, core fintech transaction engines, and asynchronous processing architectures. Expert in PHP, Laravel, Action-Service-Repository design patterns, and RESTful microservices. Strong focus on fault-tolerant systems, high-volume transactional workloads, double-entry accounting ledgers, and automated cloud workflows (CI/CD, Docker, AWS). Passionate about eliminating operational bottlenecks through robust infrastructure and clean code engineering.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages:	PHP (8.x), JavaScript (ES6+), Python (intermediate), SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL)
Frameworks & Web:	Laravel, Symfony, React.js, Smarty, WordPress (Custom plugins & themes)
Backend Architecture:	REST APIs, Event-Driven Services, Redis Queues, DTOs, Clean/Layered Architecture
DevOps & Cloud:	Docker, AWS (Fargate, S3, Lambda), DigitalOcean, Linux/UNIX, CI/CD (GitHub Actions)
Fintech & Integrity:	Double-entry Ledgers, Core Banking (Qore/BankOne), Payment Rails (Monnify, Sudo)
Testing & Standards:	PHPUnit, Feature Testing, ARCON Compliance, Vulnerability Remediation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Application Support Analyst • MTN Nigeria

Sep 2022 – Aug 2026

Lagos, Nigeria | Enterprise Telecommunications

- Engineered and maintained mission-critical internal web platforms and backend applications using PHP and WordPress.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with UNIX, Network, Database, and Security teams to troubleshoot high-severity operational incidents.
- Optimized complex database queries and streamlined caching layers, reducing server compute overhead and query latency.
- Enforced strict ARCON-related regulatory controls, vulnerability assessments, and enterprise security compliance standards.
- Authored technical documentation, runbooks, and SOPs; mentored software engineering interns on production best practices.

Full-Stack Developer • Ritemate Technologies

2026

Lagos, Nigeria | Technology Consulting & Solutions

- Delivered resilient application solutions and continuous production support within an agile client-facing consultancy framework.
- Engineered full-stack features spanning backend microservices, modern frontend interfaces, automated builds, and server deployments.
- Partnered directly with client-side engineering teams to triage production incidents, implement hotfixes, and maintain system uptime.

Lead Backend Engineer • Retruster Microfinance Application

Apr 2025 – Apr 2026

Remote | Digital Banking & Financial Services

- Architected and implemented the backend for a comprehensive microfinance banking system managing loans, savings, and wallets.
- Structured application logic using Action-Service-Repository patterns and Data Transfer Objects (DTOs) for maximum testability.
- Integrated Qore/BankOne core banking protocols and Monnify/Sudo rails for automated debiting, account creation, and batch transfers.
- Designed fault-tolerant financial flows implementing double-entry ledgers, idempotent webhook processors, and ACID transactions.
- Orchestrated Laravel Jobs and Redis queue pipelines to process asynchronous notifications, ledger reconciliations, and syncing tasks.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Backend Engineer • Atlas Trailer

Dec 2021 – Feb 2023

Remote (Canada) | Supply Chain & Logistics E-Commerce

- Architected scalable Laravel backend services powering high-volume customer booking systems and wholesale inventory workflows.
- Developed performant RESTful APIs and connected external payment gateways, courier tracking feeds, and enterprise ERP tools.
- Configured GitHub Actions CI/CD workflows and automated server maintenance on DigitalOcean, including automated database backups and SSL renewals.
- Led peer code reviews, enforced PSR standards, performed query profiling, and mentored junior developers during agile sprint cycles.

Backend Engineer • Aladdin Digital

Apr 2021 – Mar 2022

Remote | Digital Products & FinTech

- Designed and developed bespoke Laravel web applications coupled with dynamic, responsive client-side user interfaces.
- Integrated third-party APIs, merchant gateways, and webhook callbacks to support evolving multi-currency business models.
- Managed zero-downtime cloud deployments with robust SSL configurations, containerization, and regular security patching.
- Interfaced with product owners and stakeholders to translate complex business logic into efficient technical architectures.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Retrust Core Banking Infrastructure

Laravel • MySQL • Redis • Microfinance

Designed an ACID-compliant double-entry ledger managing savings, peer-to-peer transfers, and multi-tier interest disbursements with automatic reconciliation webhooks and audit trail safeguards.

COC Unite Application

Laravel • React.js • WebSockets

Engineered an interactive community platform featuring role-based access control (RBAC), live attendance logging, event scheduling, and real-time push notifications over an asynchronous service layer.

Blacklist Limited – Credit Management Engine

PHP • Laravel • Relational DB

Constructed an automated credit-risk management engine that identifies delinquent accounts, tracks repayment milestones, and enforces programmable account restriction protocols.

CSMT Schools Digital Admission Portal

PHP • WordPress • DigitalOcean

Automated candidate application intake, entrance examination credential generation, payment verification, and batch transactional email dispatch via queued background jobs.

Osamede.net Infrastructure & Client Platforms

PHP • Custom CMS • Linux

Engineered corporate web platforms for education and consulting clients, featuring custom plugin development, security hardening, automated backups, and page speed optimization.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Computer Science

Nnamdi Azikiwe University

Graduated 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

ALX x Udacity Full Stack Program

Python, Flask, SQLAlchemy, PostgreSQL

2022

Triplebyte Certified Software Engineer

Generalist Software Engineering

2022

SlateCube Full Stack Web Development

HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Modern Web

2020

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

Digital Literacy Bootcamp Lead Organizer

Self-funded, structured, and facilitated an intensive 8-day free tech training workshop in Lagos, successfully introducing 600+ underserved youth to computer programming and digital skills.

Chess in Slums Africa – Technical Volunteer

Contributed pro-bono cloud infrastructure architecture, AWS hosting administration, and custom internal dashboard tooling to empower nonprofit operational workflows.